破解霍乱之谜的医生

The Doctor Who Solved the Cholera Mystery



破解霍乱之谜，关键是地图还是饮水？

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RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In the first ten days of September 1854, cholera ravaged an overcrowded corner of London's Soho; upwards of 500 people perished. Most doctors attributed epidemics to miasma, foul air arising from filth. John Snow, a physician who had been convinced since 1849 that cholera's poison was swallowed, not inhaled, suspected the Broad Street pump.

Finding little visible impurity, he hesitated, then consulted the death register and questioned bereaved families. Most victims lived near the pump and drank from it. At his urging, parish officials removed the handle, but daily fatal attacks had already plunged from a peak of 143 to 12. He later mapped the deaths.

In 1855 Edmund Parkes, a professor of clinical medicine, interpreted the cluster on that map as a poison drifting through the air. Yet a map could chart where people died, not what they drank.

The crucial evidence, gathered in 1854, lay in exceptions. Amid the deaths in the surrounding streets, a workhouse with its own well lost a mere five of 535 inmates. More than 70 nearby brewery workers, with a beer allowance and their own well, escaped severe cholera.

Conversely, a Hampstead widow who had not set foot in Soho for months had the pump's water carted to her daily. She died, as did a visiting niece who drank it. Hampstead then had no cholera.

In 1855 a government inquiry declined to condemn the pump, contending its water had at most absorbed airborne poison. Meanwhile, the sceptical curate Henry Whitehead set out to refute Snow but found that those who drank from the pump were far more likely to succumb to the disease than others, vindicating him.

中文译文

1854年9月的头十天，霍乱在伦敦苏豪区一片人口过密的街区肆虐，500多人丧生。多数医生把流行病归因于瘴气，也就是污秽中产生的恶臭空气。医生约翰·斯诺自1849年起便确信，霍乱的致病物是被吞入人体，而不是随空气吸入；他因此怀疑宽街的公共水泵。

泵水中几乎没有肉眼可见的杂质，这让他一度犹豫。随后，他查阅死亡登记册，走访失去亲人的家庭。多数死者住在水泵附近，也喝过那里的水。在他的敦促下，教区官员拆下了泵柄；但在此之前，每天新发的致死病例数，就已经从高峰的143例骤降到12例。他后来才把死亡地点标在地图上。

1855年，临床医学教授埃德蒙·帕克斯把地图上的死亡聚集现象，解释成毒物在空气中飘散的结果。然而，地图只能记录人们死在哪里，并不能说明他们喝过什么。

真正关键的证据早在1854年就已收集到，存在于那些例外之中。周边街巷死亡接连发生，一所自备水井的济贫院，535名被收容者中却只有5人死亡。附近啤酒厂的70多名工人，既享有啤酒配给，也有自备水井，没有患上重症霍乱。

与之相反，汉普斯特德的一位寡妇，已经好几个月没有踏入苏豪区，却每天让人把宽街水泵的水用车运到家中。她去世了；来探望她、也喝了这些水的侄甥女，同样去世了。而汉普斯特德当时并没有流行霍乱。

1855年，政府的一次调查拒绝认定水泵应当负责，认为泵水充其量只是吸收了空气中的毒物。与此同时，原本持怀疑态度的助理牧师亨利·怀特黑德，着手寻找证据来驳倒斯诺，却发现喝过泵水的人，死于这种疾病的可能性远高于其他人，反倒印证了斯诺的判断。

niece可指侄女或外甥女，原文未进一步区分，译文以“侄甥女”统称。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

ravage v.
肆虐；严重毁坏
cholera ravaged an overcrowded corner

attribute v.
归因于
doctors attributed epidemics

foul adj.
恶臭的；污浊的
foul air arising from filth.

physician n.
医生
John Snow, a physician

convince v.
使确信；此处指深信不疑
convinced since 1849

consult v.
查阅
then consulted the death register

bereaved adj.
失去亲人的
questioned bereaved families.

fatal adj.
致死的
daily fatal attacks

plunge v.
骤降
had already plunged

interpret v.
解释；解读
interpreted the cluster

cluster n.
聚集；密集的一群
the cluster on that map

crucial adj.
至关重要的
The crucial evidence

exception n.
例外
lay in exceptions.

conversely adv.
相反地；反过来
Conversely, a Hampstead widow

inquiry n.
调查；官方调查
a government inquiry

decline to phr. v.
拒绝做……
declined to condemn the pump

contend v.
主张；坚持认为
contending its water had

airborne adj.
经空气传播的
airborne poison.

sceptical adj.
持怀疑态度的
the sceptical curate Henry Whitehead

refute v.
驳倒；反驳
set out to refute Snow

succumb to phr. v.
死于（疾病）；屈服于
succumb to the disease

vindicate v.
证明……正确；印证
vindicating him.

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共35项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

overcrowded adj.
人口过密的；过度拥挤的

upwards of phr.
超过

perish v.
丧生

epidemic n.
流行病；疫情

to prep.
与attribute连用，表示归因于

arise v.
产生；源于

filth n.
污秽

swallow v.
吞入

inhale v.
吸入

hesitate v.
犹豫

register n.
登记册

victim n.
受害者；此处指死者

urging n.
敦促；催促

parish n.
教区

peak n.
峰值；最高点

clinical medicine n.
临床医学

poison n.
毒物；毒素

drift v.
飘散

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共35项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

chart v.
绘制；记录分布

lie in phr. v.
在于；存在于

amid prep.
在……之中

surrounding adj.
周围的

workhouse n.
济贫院

a mere phr.
仅仅；区区

inmate n.
被收容者

allowance n.
配给；补助

widow n.
寡妇

set foot in phr.
踏入

cart v.
用车运送

niece n.
侄女；外甥女

then adv.
当时

condemn v.
谴责；认定应负责任

absorb v.
吸收

meanwhile adv.
与此同时

set out to phr. v.
着手去；打算去

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 At his urging, parish officials removed the handle, but daily _____ attacks had already plunged from a peak of 143 to 12.

02 In 1855 Edmund Parkes, a professor of clinical medicine, interpreted the _____ on that map as a poison drifting through the air.

03 The _____ evidence, gathered in 1854, lay in exceptions.

04 _____, a Hampstead widow who had not set foot in Soho for months had the pump's water carted to her daily.

文章主线

- 旧说 1854年伦敦苏豪区霍乱十日夺命逾500人；多数医生归因臭气，斯诺则怀疑饮水传播。
- 追查 他查死亡记录、访问家属，发现许多死者喝过宽街水泵的水，促使官员拆下泵柄。
- 对照 自备井的济贫院仅少数死亡，啤酒厂无人患重症；远处无疫情地区，却有两人喝泵水后死亡。
- 辨别 每日致死病例数在拆泵柄前已大幅减少；地图只标死亡地点，关键是比较人们是否喝过泵水。
- 验证 官方调查仍坚持空气传播；原想驳倒斯诺的牧师怀特黑德却发现喝泵水者更易死亡，支持了斯诺。

参考答案　1 fatal 2 cluster 3 crucial 4 Conversely